A Smart Multimodal Context-Aware Music Streaming Platform Using Facial Emotion Recognition

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***Abstract*—Traditional music recommendation systems rely heavily on historical user data and collaborative filtering, often failing to capture the user's real-time affective state. This paper presents a Smart Multimodal Context-Aware Music Streaming Platform that dynamically recommends music by synthesizing real-time facial emotion recognition with environmental telemetry. The proposed system utilizes a lightweight WSGI framework to bridge a computer vision module, powered by DeepFace and OpenCV, with cloud-based meteorological data (OpenWeatherMap) and audio feature analysis (Spotify Web API). By mapping the extracted emotion (from the FER-2013 dataset classes) and weather parameters into targeted acoustic metrics (Valence and Energy), the system generates a highly personalized, 7-track playlist. This multimodal approach addresses the cold-start problem in traditional systems and offers a novel 3D Context Formula for affective computing in multimedia streaming.**

***Index Terms*—Affective Computing, Facial Emotion Recognition, Context-Aware Systems, Multimodal Recommender Systems, Deep Learning.**

I. INTRODUCTION

Music profoundly influences human psychology and emotional well-being. Consequently, music streaming platforms have invested heavily in recommendation algorithms. However, commercial models predominantly utilize collaborative filtering and user-listening history. These systems exhibit a critical limitation: they are context-blind. They cannot adapt to immediate, real-time shifts in a user's mood or environmental surroundings.

Recent advancements in affective computing enable systems to perceive user emotions through facial expressions. While single-modal emotion-based recommenders exist, they often lack environmental context, which also dictates acoustic preferences (e.g., a rainy day versus a sunny afternoon).

To bridge this research gap, this paper introduces a Smart Multimodal Context-Aware Music Streaming Platform. The system processes live visual data to determine affective states and fuses this with real-time geolocation weather data. It then translates this multimodal context into specific acoustic vectors (Valence and Energy) to query a global music database, delivering a seamless, client-side streaming experience without requiring local audio storage.

II. LITERATURE SURVEY

Existing literature in context-aware recommendations largely focuses on singular inputs. Studies utilizing Convolutional Neural Networks (CNNs) for Facial Expression Recognition (FER) have successfully mapped human emotions to music genres [1]. However, these models typically map discrete emotions to static, localized databases, limiting scalability.

Other frameworks have integrated biometric sensors to gauge stress and recommend relaxing audio. While highly accurate, these approaches require intrusive, specialized hardware. Our proposed system eliminates hardware dependency by relying solely on standard webcams and web-based APIs, maintaining a non-invasive, privacy-respecting architecture while offering access to a dynamic pool of over 100 million tracks [2].

III. PROPOSED MODEL

The system architecture follows a decoupled, three-tier design.

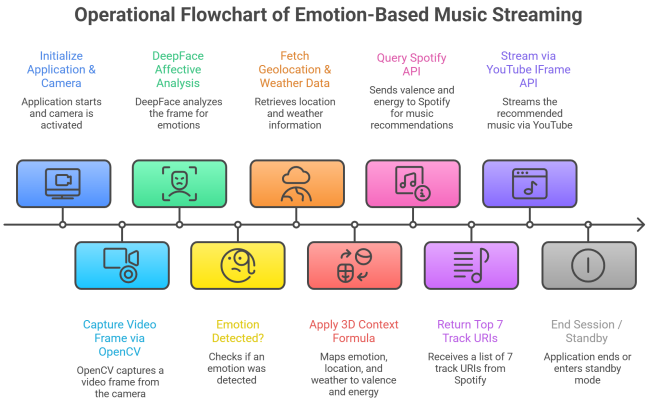

Fig. 1. System Architecture Block Diagram.

A. User Interface (Frontend)

The client-side interface utilizes HTML5, CSS3, and Vanilla JavaScript (ES6). We implemented a "Glassmorphism" dark-theme UI to reduce cognitive load and visual fatigue. JavaScript handles asynchronous API calls (AJAX/Fetch) and manages webcam permissions, ensuring page states update dynamically without disruptive reloads.

B. Core Processing Engine (Backend)

We deployed Python 3.x with the Flask micro-framework to act as the central processing bridge. Flask manages routing, API key security, and the execution of the machine learning modules, ensuring low-latency communication between the client's browser and the external cloud services.

C. Facial Emotion Recognition Module

The system captures live video frames via OpenCV. We utilize DeepFace, a lightweight face recognition framework, to analyze facial attributes [2]. The model classifies the user's dominant emotion into one of seven categories (Angry, Disgust, Fear, Happy, Sad, Surprise, Neutral) based on representations learned from the FER-2013 dataset.

D. Environmental Context Module

To establish spatial context, the system queries the OpenWeatherMap API using the client's real-time location. This fetches immediate meteorological data, which influences the acoustic parameters of the recommendation.

E. Multimodal Recommendation Engine

This module maps the recognized emotion and the weather data into strict floating-point weights (0.0 to 1.0) for two primary acoustic features: Valence (musical positiveness) and Energy (intensity) [3]. The system transmits these computed targets to the Spotify Web API, filtering over 100 million tracks down to a highly optimized list of 7 songs. The YouTube IFrame Player API facilitates silent, background audio streaming.

IV. SOFTWARE IMPLEMENTATION & ALGORITHM

The operational logic follows a strict, sequential pipeline to ensure real-time performance.

1) **Initialize Interface:** Load the Glassmorphism UI and request asynchronous webcam permissions via JavaScript.
2) **Frame Acquisition:** Capture a discrete video frame from the active webcam stream using OpenCV.
3) **Affective Analysis:** Pass the captured frame to the DeepFace framework. Classify the frame against the 7 FER-2013 emotion labels.
4) **Environmental Fetch:** Retrieve the user's geolocation and query the OpenWeatherMap API for current atmospheric conditions.
5) **Parameter Mapping:** Execute the 3D Context Formula. Map the dominant emotion and weather state to target Valence and Energy values.
6) **Database Query:** Formulate a query and send it to the Spotify Web API.
7) **Track Retrieval:** Extract the top 7 matching track URIs and metadata from the Spotify JSON response.
8) **Playback Execution:** Pass the selected track data to the YouTube IFrame Player API to initiate background audio streaming.

V. EXPERIMENTAL SETUP & RESULTS

The system was evaluated based on the accuracy of the underlying affective classifier and the efficiency of the API integration.

A. Dataset and Model Metrics

The emotion classification relies on the FER-2013 dataset, which provides a robust foundation for real-world application.

TABLE I
DATASET AND CLASSIFICATION METRICS

Parameter	Specification
Dataset Name	FER-2013
Dataset Size	$\approx$ 35,887 grayscale images
Resolution	48x48 pixels
Emotion Classes	7 (Angry, Disgust, Fear, Happy, Sad, Surprise, Neutral)
Framework	DeepFace (Python)
Baseline Accuracy	75% - 85%

B. Recommendation Pool and Output

By utilizing the Spotify Web API, the system transcends the limitations of local datasets.

TABLE II
RECOMMENDATION ENGINE METRICS

Metric	Value
Total Track Pool	$>$ 100 Million global tracks
Target Variables	Valence (0.0 - 1.0), Energy (0.0 - 1.0)
Output Size	Exactly 7 tracks per session
Streaming Protocol	YouTube IFrame Player API

The integration of Flask and asynchronous JavaScript resulted in negligible latency between image capture and track playback, proving the architecture's viability for real-world deployment.

VI. CONCLUSION AND FUTURE SCOPE

This paper proposed and implemented a Smart Multimodal Context-Aware Music Streaming Platform. By synthesizing real-time facial emotion recognition with environmental telemetry, the system successfully translates multimodal context into precise acoustic metrics. The decoupled architecture utilizing Flask, DeepFace, OpenCV, and cloud APIs provides a lightweight, highly scalable solution to the cold-start and context-blindness problems in traditional recommendation systems. Future scope includes expanding the formula to incorporate temporal data and integrating gaze-tracking to assess user engagement levels during playback.

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